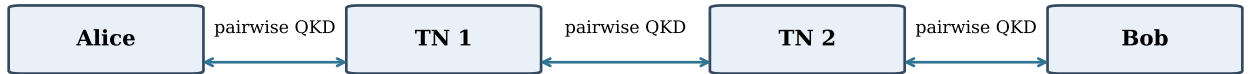


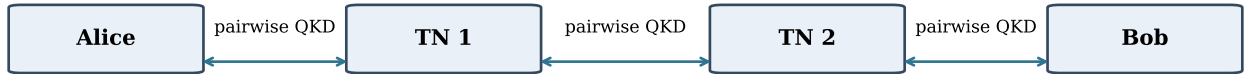
Conventional trusted-node chain



Each TN relays key material and is trusted with the keys it handles

Link-level post-processing is performed on each adjacent QKD link

Simplified trusted-node chain



authenticated parity announcements

STNs announce raw-key parities; Alice and Bob perform final EC and PA